



Abdulla Abdulrahman Y. AlBassam

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EDUCATION

Northumbria University, Newcastle

Expected: July 2026

BSc (Honors), Networks and Cyber Security

Predicted: 1st Class Honours

Kings College London

June 2023

Foundation Year

Economics and Mathematics

Modern Knowledge Schools, Bahrain

May 2022

American High School Diploma

GPA: 98%

HONOURS AND AWARDS:

- Emdad Scholarship Recipient | 2022–2026
- Innovation Award | Anthropic x Accenture Hackathon | May 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Scripting: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, React (Native), PHP, HTML, Bash, SQL.

Virtualisation and Supplementary Tools: Docker, VMware, Git/GitHub, Microsoft Office.

Security and Networking: Wireshark, Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, Snort, iptables, Hydra; GNS3, Cisco Packet Tracer, Kali Linux.

AI/ML: Jupyter, Google Colab, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn; PyTorch/Transformers, Claude Code.

PROJECTS

Local Mail Server with Cascade AI Spam Filter | Bachelor's Dissertation | Sep 2025 – May 2026

- Built a secure local email system integrating baseline and advanced spam filters via a filter pipeline to evaluate robustness against adversarial attacks.

Enterprise Networking | Oct 2025 – Jan 2026

- Designed and simulated a multi-site enterprise WAN in GNS3 using an MPLS VPN core with dynamic routing, delivering site-to-site connectivity across multiple branch networks plus an additional direct VPN link between critical sites, with selective IPsec encryption applied to balance security and performance.

CTFs, Penetration Testing, and Defensive Security | Dec 2025 – Present

- Conducted vulnerability assessments on Vuln VMs and OWASP Juice Shop using tools such as Nmap, and Burp Suite. Reported findings, impact, and remediation.
- Implemented defensive controls (iptables rulesets, Snort IDS/IPS rules, OS hardening) and executed controlled credential testing with Hydra.
- Independently completed offensive security CTF challenges including Windows/Linux exploitation, privilege escalation, web application attacks, and password cracking.

URL Triage Agent | May 2026

- Built an autonomous AI agent that triages URLs running on a tool-use loop over ten investigative tools (WHOIS, DNS, TLS, etc...).
- Returns an analyst-grade verdict, confidence score, and evidence—turning minutes of manual SOC triage into seconds.

Digital Forensics Investigation | Feb 2025 – May 2025

- Carried out a forensic examination of two devices to recover all relevant evidence and further understand the suspects motives, goals and objectives. Identified and evaluated findings from forensics investigations on FTK & Autopsy applying appropriate legal and procedural principles.

Computing Consultancy | Client Deliverable | Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Assessed a small Newcastle business's security posture and delivered actionable vulnerability assessment in a client-facing consulting capacity.

System Architecture | Sep 2024 – Apr 2025

- Designed and implemented a secure, object-oriented REST API in PHP with an SQL database for a multi-platform academic conference system, following industry coding and security standards.

Sweaty: Video Game Social Platform | Oct 2025 – Present

- Building a social platform mobile app to track what you're playing, rate games, write reviews and share your gaming journey. Full-stack TypeScript across a React Native client, a Next.js 16 web layer on Vercel, and Postgres handling auth, storage, real-time interactions and activity feed.
- Security as a focus: row-level security on every Postgres table, server-side session validation, HMAC-signed OAuth.
- Self-Audited the codebase, closing IDOR, PostgREST injection and email-enumeration vulnerabilities.

Side Projects | 2025 – Present

- Shipped a range of full-stack side projects: a native macOS ad blocker (Swift, Rust via FFI), a manifesto-cited UK-politics explainer (FastAPI, React, Claude API), a gamified cybersecurity learning platform (JavaScript), and a personal portfolio site (Astro, Svelte, Tailwind).

INDUSTRY CERTIFICATIONS

Junior Penetration Tester (eJPT) – INE, *In progress* | CCNA: Enterprise Networking, Security, and Automation – Cisco, Jan 2026 | CC: Certified in Cybersecurity – INE2, August 2025